Cross spectra between thin redshift bins

Which pairs the data vector measures, and how the
Fingers-of-God blur changes their overlap

November 2026

1 Summary

The questions. The forecast cuts the DESI galaxies into thin redshift bins and measures the angular power spectrum of every bin. For some pairs of bins it also measures their cross spectrum, the correlation between the two bins' maps. Four bin layouts slice the galaxies: $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc, 76 bins of equal comoving depth, and three of fixed redshift width, $\Delta z = 0.02$, 0.05 and 0.2, with 90, 36 and 10 bins. The first two are the thin layouts. This note answers three questions:

1. Which pairs of bins have their cross spectrum in the data vector, and why those?
2. What does that rule mean in redshift, on each of the four bin layouts?
3. How does the Fingers-of-God (FoG) blur, at its default strength, change how much neighbouring bins overlap?

The answers.

1. A pair is measured when the two bins' redshift distributions $n(z)$ overlap or touch. That gives the neighbours along each galaxy sample's chain of bins, plus the pairs of an LRG bin and an ELG bin at the same redshift: at $0.8 < z < 1.1$ the LRG3 and ELG1 groups are two galaxy samples observing one volume (Figures 1 and 2). The four layouts measure 97, 133, 52 and 13 cross spectra.
2. On the layouts of fixed redshift width only adjacent bins pair. On $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc the rule is adjacency in comoving distance, which no single cut in redshift can express: a bin of fixed comoving depth is 0.015 wide in redshift at $z = 0.1$ and 0.035 at $z = 1.5$.
3. The blur has a width of 5–6 Mpc along the line of sight, about a tenth of a thin bin. It raises the overlap of two neighbouring thin bins from about 0.003, the one grid step where their tabulated edges meet, to about 0.06. Bins one apart stay disjoint. On $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc, ten LRG3–ELG1 pairs that the data vector does not measure overlap by 0.03 once blurred, half of what a measured neighbour pair does (Figure 3).

2 Why cross spectra between thin bins matter

The angular power spectrum. Take the galaxies of bin i and draw a map of their number on the sky: $\delta_i(\hat{n})$ is the fractional excess of galaxies in the direction $\hat{n}$ over the mean. Expand the map in spherical harmonics, $\delta_i(\hat{n}) = \sum_{\ell m} a^i_{\ell m} Y_{\ell m}(\hat{n})$. The multipole ℓ labels an angular scale of about $180°/\ell$: $\ell = 20$ is about 9°, $\ell = 500$ about 0.4°.

The auto spectrum of bin i is the variance of its coefficients, $C_\ell^{ii} = \langle |a_{\ell m}^i|^2 \rangle$; the cross spectrum of bins i and j is their covariance, $C_\ell^{ij} = \langle a_{\ell m}^i a_{\ell m}^{j*} \rangle$. Two unrelated maps have a cross spectrum that averages to zero; two maps of the same structures have a positive one. The data vector holds these spectra in 53 bands of width $\Delta\ell = 10$ over $15 \leq \ell \leq 544$.

Why neighbouring thin bins correlate. A thin bin is a shell of the universe a few tens of Mpc deep: 62 Mpc on $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc, and between 37 and 85 Mpc for $\Delta z = 0.02$. The matter distribution has structures of every size. One that is 200 Mpc across spans three or four such shells, and each of them sees it in the same direction on the sky. Their maps share it, so the cross spectrum of two neighbouring shells is large at the angular scale of that structure. A structure a few Mpc across sits in one shell only, unless it sits where two shells meet.

Limber and non-Limber. These two cases are the two regimes of a cross spectrum. At high ℓ the Limber approximation [1] holds: only Fourier modes perpendicular to the line of sight contribute, and

$$C_\ell^{ij} \;\simeq\; \int d\chi \, \frac{W_i(\chi)\, W_j(\chi)}{\chi^2} \, P\!\left(k = \frac{\ell + 1/2}{\chi}\right), \tag{1}$$

with χ the comoving distance, $W_i(\chi)$ the redshift distribution of bin i written per unit comoving distance, and $P(k)$ the power spectrum of the galaxy density at wavenumber k. Two shells whose W do not overlap then have no cross spectrum. At low ℓ the approximation fails for thin shells: modes with a component along the line of sight longer than the shell depth connect shells that do not touch. The forecast computes every spectrum without the Limber approximation, so it keeps that low-ℓ correlation.

Where the radial information sits. Slicing a sample into thin shells keeps information along the line of sight: a shell of depth $\Delta\chi$ resolves line-of-sight wavenumbers up to about $\pi/\Delta\chi$, $0.05\,\mathrm{Mpc}^{-1}$ for 62 Mpc. The auto spectra say how clustered each shell is; the cross spectra say how the clustering of one shell continues into the next.

How much the cross spectra are worth depends on the bin layout: the thinner the shells, the more of the line-of-sight information sits in the cross spectra between neighbours rather than in the auto spectra.

3 The six groups and the LRG–ELG overlap

Three galaxy samples. DESI selects three kinds of galaxies, each by its own colours and brightness, and each fills the redshifts where it is bright and numerous enough to observe:

- **BGS**, the Bright Galaxy Survey: the brightest galaxies at low redshift, here $0.1 < z < 0.4$;
- **LRG**, luminous red galaxies: massive galaxies that stopped forming stars, $0.4 < z < 1.1$;
- **ELG**, emission-line galaxies: star-forming galaxies, found by the bright emission lines of their gas, $0.8 < z < 1.6$.

Nothing forces these ranges to tile the redshift axis. LRG and ELG both cover $0.8 < z < 1.1$.

Six groups. The forecast splits the samples into six groups by the bins' mean redshift $\bar{z}_i$, and gives each group its own bias parameters (Table 1): BGS whole; LRG1 ($\bar{z}_i < 0.6$), LRG2 ($0.6 \le \bar{z}_i < 0.8$) and LRG3 ($\bar{z}_i \ge 0.8$); ELG1 ($\bar{z}_i < 1.1$) and ELG2 ($\bar{z}_i \ge 1.1$). LRG3 and ELG1 are therefore two different galaxy populations in the same volume, at $z \approx 0.8$–1.1.

group	sample	bins	$\bar{z}_i$
BGS	bright galaxies	1–18	0.11–0.38
LRG1	luminous red galaxies	19–29	0.41–0.60
LRG2	luminous red galaxies	30–38	0.62–0.79
LRG3	luminous red galaxies	39–49	0.81–1.06
ELG1	emission-line galaxies	50–61	0.81–1.09
ELG2	emission-line galaxies	62–76	1.11–1.55

Table 1: The six groups of $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc, with bins numbered from 1 in data-vector order. LRG3 and ELG1 cover the same redshifts.

The numbering runs group by group. Bins are numbered in the order of the data vector: all BGS bins by increasing redshift, then all LRG bins, then all ELG bins. The numbering therefore jumps back in redshift between bins 49 and 50: bin 49 (LRG3) has $\bar{z} = 1.060$, bin 50 (ELG1) has $\bar{z} = 0.812$. Two bins far apart in number can sit at the same redshift: LRG3 bin 44 has $\bar{z} = 0.932$ and ELG1 bin 55 has $\bar{z} = 0.931$.

What the LRG–ELG cross spectrum measures. An LRG bin and an ELG bin at the same redshift sample the same matter with different galaxies. On large scales a galaxy map is the matter map times a number, the linear bias b_i of the bin, so their cross spectrum is about $b_i b_j$ times the matter spectrum, while the two autos are about b_i^2 and b_j^2 times it. The three spectra together tie the two biases to each other. Two tracers of the same structures also share the random fluctuations of those structures, so comparing them measures their bias ratio with less of that randomness than either map alone (the multi-tracer idea [2]).

Shot noise and the stochastic terms. A galaxy map is made of discrete objects, so even a random scatter of galaxies has a nonzero auto spectrum: the shot noise, $1/\bar{n}_i$ for a bin of $\bar{n}_i$ galaxies per steradian. A cross spectrum has no shot noise, because no galaxy is in two bins: within one sample each galaxy has one measured redshift, and two samples are different galaxies.

The one-loop model adds stochastic terms beyond this Poisson noise, SN_0 and SN_2. They are properties of the three-dimensional galaxy field, so they reach the cross spectrum of two bins of one sample through the overlap of their kernels, $\int d\chi\, W_i W_j/\chi^2$ for SN_0 and the same integral of the kernels' radial derivatives for SN_2 (`stochastic_templates` in `likelihood/desi_cl.py`). An LRG–ELG pair gets none: two different populations do not share a stochastic term, and the model has no separate cross-stochasticity parameter.

4 Which pairs are measured

The rule. Each bin's raw $n(z)$ is the histogram of the measured redshifts of its galaxies, tabulated on the DESI redshift grid of step $h = 3.5 \times 10^{-4}$. Let $z_i^{\rm lo}$ and $z_i^{\rm hi}$ be the first and last

grid redshifts where $n_i(z)$ is nonzero. Bins i and j pair when their ranges overlap or touch:

$$z_j^{\mathrm{lo}} \le z_i^{\mathrm{hi}} + 1.5\,h \quad \text{and} \quad z_i^{\mathrm{lo}} \le z_j^{\mathrm{hi}} + 1.5\,h. \tag{2}$$

The slack of 1.5 grid steps is there because two neighbouring bins of one sample either share their edge node or sit one node apart; 1.5 steps catches both and nothing farther.

For example, on $\Delta z = 0.02$ bin 1 ends at $z = 0.1198$ and bin 2 starts one grid step later, at 0.1202: they pair. Bin 3 starts at 0.1401, 0.020 after the end of bin 1: bins 1 and 3 do not pair.

Where the pair lists come from. For the three fixed-Δz layouts the rule writes the pair list (`cross_pairs` in `scripts/make_desi_dz_case.py`). On $\Delta d_{\mathrm{com}} = 62$ Mpc the list comes from the DESI forecast's data file (a `sacc` file), which pairs bins by redshift proximity; `scripts/make_desi_dataset.py` imports it. The rule reproduces 96 of its 97 pairs. The exception is the boundary pair of BGS bin 18 and LRG1 bin 19: BGS ends at $z = 0.390$ and LRG starts at $z = 0.400$, so their ranges are 0.010 apart, and the forecast includes them anyway.

The counts. Table 2 sorts every layout's pairs by kind. Most join a bin to the next one of its sample. The rest join an LRG and an ELG bin: the LRG3–ELG1 pairs of the shared volume, one LRG2–ELG1 pair at $z = 0.8$ where LRG2 ends and ELG1 begins, and, on $\Delta z = 0.02$ and 0.05, one LRG3–ELG2 pair at $z = 1.1$. Each bin has 1 to 4 cross partners on $\Delta d_{\mathrm{com}} = 62$ Mpc and $\Delta z = 0.2$, and 1 to 5 on $\Delta z = 0.02$ and 0.05; the first and last bins have one.

layout	bins	next bin	BGS–LRG1	LRG3–ELG1	LRG–ELG, other	total
$\Delta d_{\mathrm{com}} = 62$ Mpc	76	73	1	22	1	97
$\Delta z = 0.02$	90	87	1	43	2	133
$\Delta z = 0.05$	36	33	1	16	2	52
$\Delta z = 0.2$	10	7	1	4	1	13

Table 2: The measured cross spectra of each layout, by kind. "Next bin": two consecutive bins of one sample; BGS–LRG1: the pair across the BGS–LRG boundary at $z = 0.4$; "LRG–ELG, other": the LRG2–ELG1 pair at $z = 0.8$ and the LRG3–ELG2 pair at $z = 1.1$.

How to read Figure 1. Each block is one layout. Its upper panel draws every bin's raw $n(z)$ at unit peak, BGS and LRG in the upper lane, ELG in the lower one; two bins that touch share an edge. Its lower panel is the pair graph: a dot per bin at $\bar{z}_i$ and a segment per measured pair. The segments inside a row are the chain of neighbours; the segments between the rows are the LRG–ELG pairs, all inside the gray band where LRG3 and ELG1 share a volume, or at its edges. On $\Delta z = 0.02$ the LRG and ELG bins have the same edges, so each LRG3 bin touches three ELG1 bins: the one at its redshift and the two beside it. Figure 2 magnifies the corner where LRG2 ends and LRG3 and ELG1 begin.

5 What the rule means in redshift

Centre separations. A rule in terms of ranges can be compared with a rule in terms of centres: is there a separation $|\bar{z}_i - \bar{z}_j|$ below which every pair is measured and above which

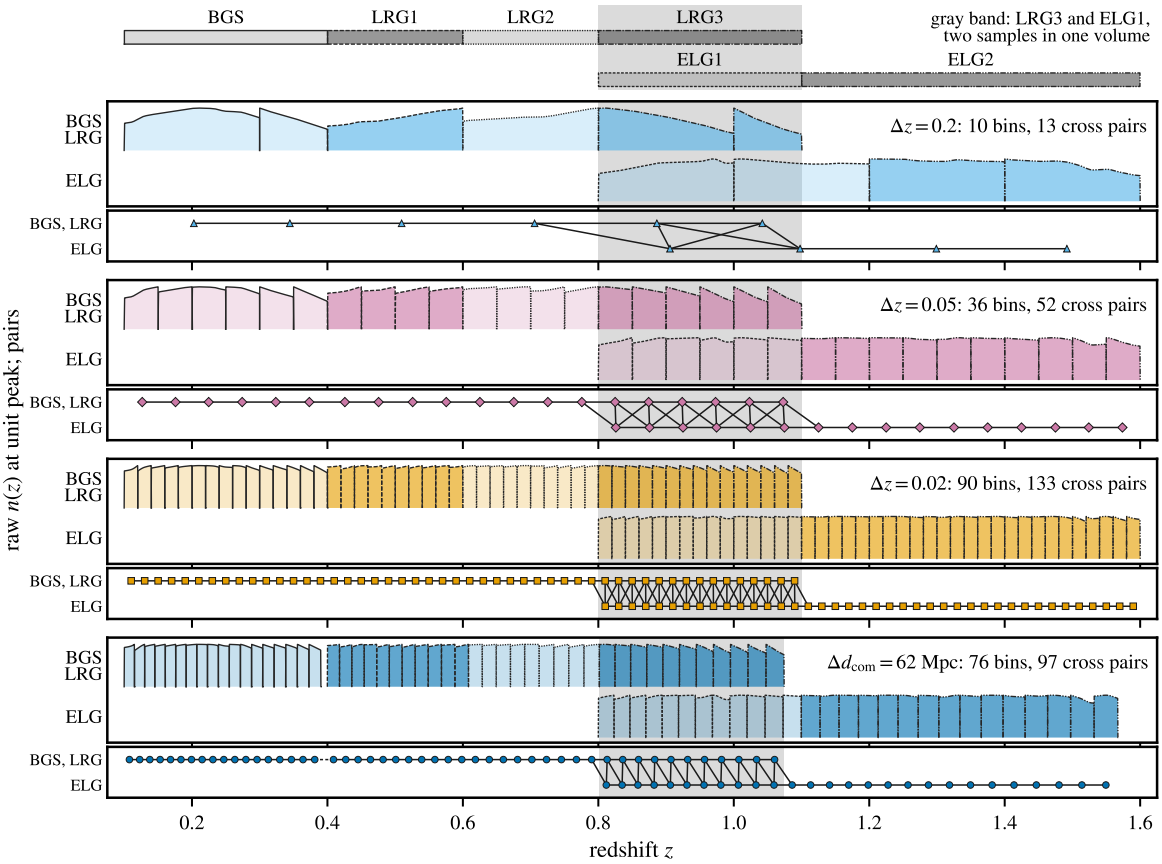


Figure 1: Every thin bin of the four layouts and the cross spectra the data vector measures. Upper panel of each block: each bin's raw $n(z)$ at unit peak, BGS and LRG in the upper lane, ELG in the lower; fill shade and outline style mark the six groups (header). Lower panel: a dot per bin at its mean redshift and a segment per measured pair; dashed: the BGS–LRG1 pair of $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc, whose ranges do not touch. Gray band: the redshifts where LRG3 and ELG1 both have bins.

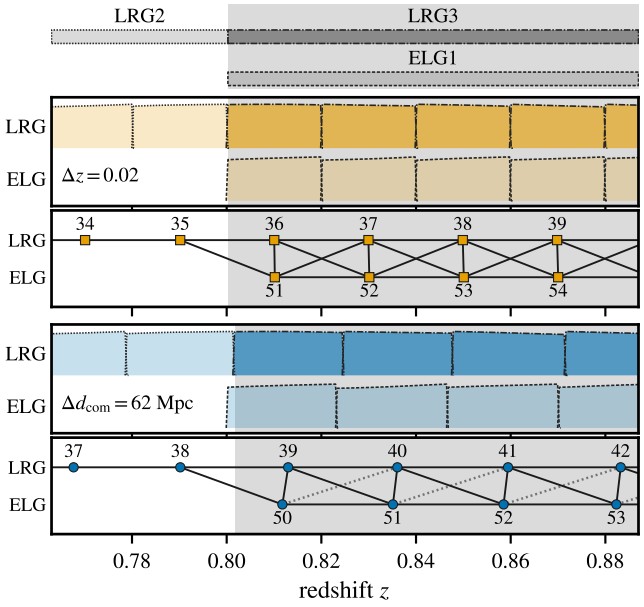


Figure 2: The corner of Figure 1 where LRG2 ends and LRG3 and ELG1 begin, on the two thin layouts, with every bin numbered in data-vector order. Solid segments: measured pairs. Dotted gray: unmeasured LRG3–ELG1 pairs of $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc whose raw ranges miss by 3 to 5 grid steps and whose blurred $n(z)$ overlap (Section 6). A segment leaving the panel joins a bin outside it.

none is? Table 3 gives, per layout, the largest separation of a measured pair and the smallest of an unmeasured one.

layout	bin width in z	largest measured	smallest unmeasured
$\Delta z = 0.2$	0.1–0.2	0.211 (LRG3 5, ELG1 8)	0.257 (LRG3 6, ELG2 9)
$\Delta z = 0.05$	0.05	0.053 (BGS 6, LRG1 7)	0.097 (LRG3 18, ELG1 22)
$\Delta z = 0.02$	0.02	0.020 (LRG3 48, ELG1 64)	0.040 (LRG3 45, ELG1 58)
$\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc	0.015–0.035	0.035 (ELG2 75, 76)	0.024 (LRG3 40, ELG1 50)

Table 3: The separation $|\bar{z}_i - \bar{z}_j|$ of the mean redshifts of the farthest measured pair and of the closest unmeasured pair, with their groups and bin numbers. On $\Delta z = 0.2$ the bins at the ends of some samples are 0.1 wide.

Fixed redshift width: only adjacent bins. On the three fixed-Δz layouts the two columns are separated by about a factor of two: neighbours are one width apart, the next bin over is two widths apart. Any cut between the two columns, for example at 0.03 on $\Delta z = 0.02$, reproduces the rule. So on these layouts the rule means: only adjacent bins pair, where an LRG bin and an ELG bin with the same range count as adjacent (separation near zero). The edge bins of $\Delta z = 0.2$, 0.1 wide, shift the numbers but not the conclusion.

Fixed comoving width: no redshift cut works. On $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc the columns cross: a measured pair is 0.035 apart and an unmeasured one 0.024. The reason is how a shell of fixed depth looks in redshift. The comoving distance is $\chi(z) = \int_0^z c\,dz'/H(z')$, with $H(z)$ the expansion rate, so a shell of depth $\Delta d_{\rm com}$ spans $\Delta z \approx \Delta d_{\rm com}\,H(z)/c$ in redshift. H grows with z, so the same 62 Mpc covers 0.015 in redshift at $\bar{z} = 0.11$ and 0.035 at $\bar{z} = 1.55$.

Two examples make this concrete. BGS bins 1 and 3, one bin apart at $z \approx 0.12$, are only 0.030 apart in mean redshift and not paired; ELG2 bins 75 and 76, neighbours at $z \approx 1.53$, are 0.035 apart and paired. The rule is adjacency in comoving distance, and in redshift that adjacency stretches with z.

Misaligned LRG and ELG edges. The closest unmeasured pair of $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc, LRG3 bin 40 and ELG1 bin 50, has a second cause. Each sample has its own bin edges: the LRG bins begin at $z = 0.400$ and the ELG bins at $z = 0.800$. In the shared volume the LRG edges sit 0.001–0.002 above the ELG edges (Figure 2, bottom). An LRG3 bin therefore overlaps the ELG1 bin at its redshift and the one above it, and starts just above the end of the one below it. Bin 40 begins 0.0014 above the end of bin 50: 4 grid steps, more than the rule's 1.5, so the pair is not measured, although their centres are only one bin width apart. This is why each LRG3 bin has two ELG1 partners on $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc, 22 pairs in all, against three on $\Delta z = 0.02$.

6 The Fingers-of-God blur

6.1 What it is

Redshift is not distance. The forecast places each galaxy by its measured redshift. That redshift has two parts: the cosmological redshift, set by the galaxy's distance, and a Doppler shift from the galaxy's own velocity v along the line of sight, its peculiar velocity. The two multiply, $1 + z_{\rm obs} = (1 + z)(1 + v/c)$, so for $v \ll c$

$$z_{\rm obs} - z \;\simeq\; (1 + z)\,\frac{v}{c}. \tag{3}$$

For example, $v = 350$ km/s at $z = 0.5$ shifts the redshift by 1.75×10^{-3}. In distance this is $\delta\chi = c\,\delta z/H(z) = (1 + z)\,v/H(z) \approx 6$ Mpc, with $H(0.5) = 88$ km/s/Mpc in the examples' cosmology ($H_0 = 67.32$ km/s/Mpc, $\Omega_m = 0.3$).

Fingers of God. Inside groups and clusters, galaxies orbit their common halo with random speeds of several hundred km/s. In a map that places every galaxy at its redshift distance, a cluster is stretched along the line of sight into a long finger pointing at the observer: the Fingers of God [3]. The orderly infall of galaxies onto large structures is a different effect, the Kaiser distortion [4], which the model computes separately.

What it does to a thin bin. A bin collects the galaxies whose measured redshift falls inside its range: a sharp cut in $z_{\rm obs}$. The matter that the galaxies trace sits at their true distances. A galaxy just outside the range, moving towards it, is measured inside; one just inside, moving away, is measured outside. So the galaxies of the bin trace the matter over a slightly wider, softer-edged range than the histogram of their measured redshifts. The same

convolution describes a sharp shell in true redshift observed blurred along the line of sight; for a symmetric velocity distribution the two descriptions agree.

6.2 The model in the likelihood

The likelihood replaces each bin's raw $n_i(z)$ by its convolution with a Gaussian in redshift [5],

$$n_i^{\mathrm{FoG}}(z) = \int dz'\, n_i(z')\, \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}\,\sigma_{z,i}}\, \exp\left[-\frac{(z-z')^2}{2\sigma_{z,i}^2}\right], \qquad \sigma_{z,i} = (1+\bar{z}_i)\,\frac{\sigma_v}{c}, \tag{4}$$

with σ_v the velocity dispersion of the bin's group, the standard deviation of the line-of-sight velocities, and $c = 299792.458$ km/s. The width follows from Eq. (3).

The code is `set_lens_related` in `likelihood/desi_cl.py`. It convolves a copy of each raw histogram with `scipy.ndimage.gaussian_filter1d` on the $n(z)$ table's grid, the DESI grid refined five-fold (step 7.0×10^{-5}, so $\sigma_{z,i}$ spans 20 to 36 steps), with the width in grid steps and zero beyond the grid ends. The Gaussian is truncated at $4\sigma_{z,i}$, scipy's default. The σ_v are sampled parameters, so the convolution runs again at every sampled point. The figures of this note repeat that call; at the default σ_v the result equals, bit for bit, the convolved tables that the covariance adapter writes with the same call (`covariance/<layout>_fog.nz`).

6.3 Where the velocity dispersions come from

The source forecast measured the line-of-sight velocity dispersion of its simulated galaxies as a function of redshift, with an error bar per bin. The project reads one value per group off that measurement (Table 4). The measured curve steps inside BGS, between the bins at $\bar{z} = 0.247$ and 0.263, so BGS takes two values, split at $z = 0.255$: seven dispersion groups for six bias groups.

group	σ_v [km/s]	prior width [km/s]	$\sigma_{z,i}$ [10^{-3}]	$\delta\chi$ [Mpc]
BGS, $\bar{z}_i < 0.255$	371	145	1.37–1.54	5.8–6.1
BGS, $\bar{z}_i \geq 0.255$	358	105	1.51–1.65	5.9–6.0
LRG1	357	70	1.68–1.90	6.0–6.1
LRG2	348	50	1.88–2.08	6.0
LRG3	343	50	2.07–2.36	5.8–5.9
ELG1	304	40	1.84–2.12	5.1–5.2
ELG2	289	30	2.04–2.46	4.6–4.8

Table 4: The default velocity dispersion of each group, the width of its Gaussian prior, and the resulting redshift width $\sigma_{z,i}$ and comoving width $\delta\chi = (1+\bar{z}_i)\,\sigma_v/H(\bar{z}_i)$ over the bins of $\Delta d_{\mathrm{com}} = 62$ Mpc.

Each prior is a Gaussian centred on the default, five times as wide as the per-bin error bar of the measurement, and truncated at zero. The defaults live in `likelihood/params_desi*.yaml` (the `DESI_SIGV` parameters; the first bin of each group carries the prior and the others are tied to it), and the same seven values in `CHUNK_SIGMA_V` of `covariance/lssty1xdesi_covariance.py`, which convolves the covariance's kernels at fixed σ_v. The ELG dispersions are the lowest, as expected for star-forming galaxies, which tend to live in lighter halos with slower orbits.

6.4 How large the blur is

A nearly constant width in distance. In comoving distance the blur is $\delta\chi = (1 + z)\,\sigma_v/H(z)$ (last column of Table 4): 5.8–6.1 Mpc for BGS and LRG and 4.6–5.2 Mpc for ELG, at every redshift. It barely changes with z because $(1 + z)/H(z)$ changes by at most 10% over $0.1 < z < 1.6$.

Against the bin width. What matters for overlap is $\sigma_{z,i}$ divided by the bin's width w_i, the redshift range its galaxies were selected in. On $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc it is the same ratio in distance, $\delta\chi/62$ Mpc: 0.069–0.096, about a tenth of the bin at every redshift. On $\Delta z = 0.02$ it grows with redshift, from 0.069 to 0.125, because a fixed Δz is a thinner shell at high z. On $\Delta z = 0.05$ it is 0.028–0.050, and on $\Delta z = 0.2$ 0.007–0.023 (Figure 3, top right).

A Gaussian blur of a sharp edge moves a fraction of about $\sigma_z/(\sqrt{2\pi}\,w)$ of a bin's galaxies across each edge. The blurred $n(z)$ of a thin bin has 5–8% of its weight outside its raw range on $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc and 5–10% on $\Delta z = 0.02$, against 2–4% on $\Delta z = 0.05$ and 0.5–2% on $\Delta z = 0.2$. That weight lies inside the neighbouring bins.

6.5 What it does to the overlap

A measure of overlap. For two bins define the normalized overlap integral

$$O_{ij} \;=\; \frac{\int dz\, n_i(z)\, n_j(z)}{\sqrt{\int dz\, n_i^2(z)\;\int dz\, n_j^2(z)}}, \tag{5}$$

1 for two identical distributions and 0 for disjoint ones, whatever their normalization. It has a direct meaning. In the Limber regime, Eq. (1), the power spectrum and χ barely change across two thin bins, so O_{ij} is close to the correlation coefficient $C_\ell^{ij}/\sqrt{C_\ell^{ii}C_\ell^{jj}}$ of the two bins at high ℓ. The SN_0 cross term of Section 3 is nearly the same integral.

Neighbours. Without the blur, two neighbouring bins touch only over the one grid step where their tabulated edges meet, and their overlap is about $h/(6\,w)$: 0.0015–0.0039 on $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc, 0.0027–0.0029 on $\Delta z = 0.02$, 0.0011–0.0012 on $\Delta z = 0.05$ and 0.0003–0.0004 on $\Delta z = 0.2$. This number measures the grid, not the galaxies. With the blur at the default σ_v the edges become ramps about $4\sigma_z$ wide, and the overlap becomes about $0.6\,\sigma_z/w$: 0.039–0.061 on $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc (median 0.057), 0.043–0.083 on $\Delta z = 0.02$ (0.066), 0.018–0.032 on $\Delta z = 0.05$ (0.024) and 0.006–0.009 on $\Delta z = 0.2$ (0.007). On the thin layouts this is a 6% correlation at high ℓ that the raw $n(z)$ would put at 0.3%.

Bins one apart stay disjoint. The bin between them is at least $8\sigma_z$ wide, and the Gaussian is truncated at $4\sigma_z$, so the blurred $n(z)$ of two bins one apart do not meet. The only exception is the last ELG2 bins of $\Delta z = 0.02$, where $\sigma_z/w = 0.125$ and the truncated tails touch, with an overlap below 2×10^{-14}. Even an untruncated Gaussian gives two blurred top hats one bin apart a percent-level overlap only at $\sigma_z \approx 0.4\,w$, four times the default on the thin layouts. Within two prior widths of every default σ_z/w stays below 0.2, where that overlap is below 2×10^{-5}.

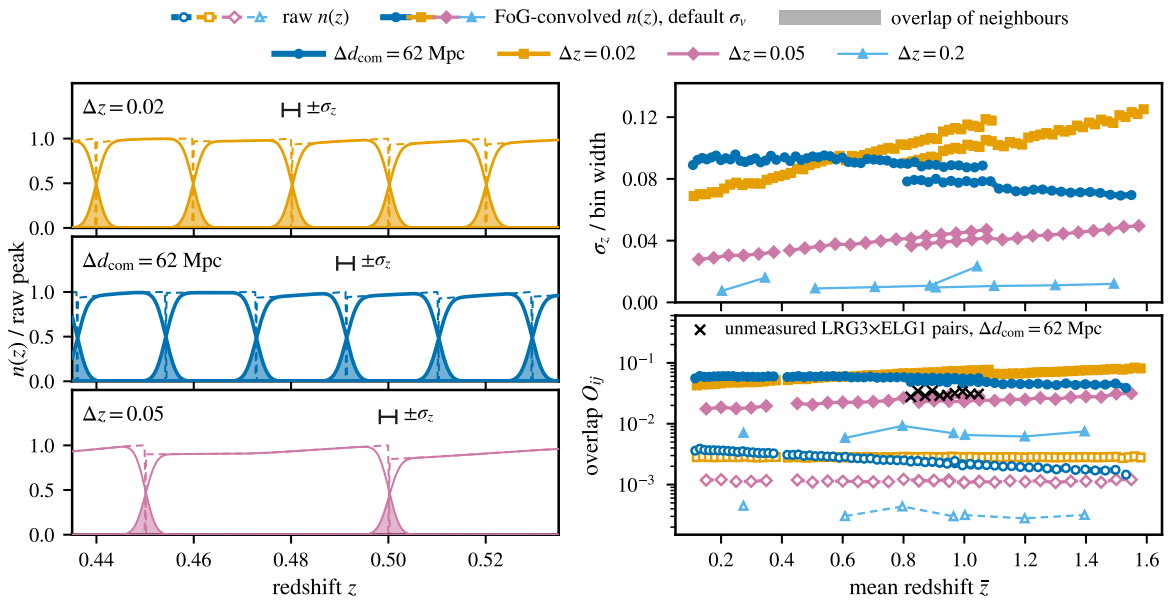


Figure 3: The Fingers-of-God blur at the default σ_v. Left: raw (dashed) and blurred (solid) $n(z)$ of the LRG1 bins in $0.435 < z < 0.535$ on three layouts, each divided by its raw peak; shaded: the overlap $\min(n_i, n_j)$ of neighbouring blurred bins; bar: $\pm\sigma_z$. Right: σ_z over the bin width, and the overlap O_{ij} of Eq. (5) for consecutive bins of one sample, raw (dashed, open markers) and blurred (solid, filled), against the mean redshift. Crosses: the ten unmeasured LRG3–ELG1 pairs of $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc, whose raw overlap is zero. Bins one apart overlap by at most 2×10^{-14}, raw or blurred.

The misaligned LRG3–ELG1 pairs. The blur does change one set of pairs. On $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc the ten unmeasured pairs of an LRG3 bin and the ELG1 bin ending just below it (bins 40 to 49 with 50 to 59; Section 5) have raw ranges 3 to 5 grid steps apart, less than σ_z, and zero raw overlap. Blurred, they overlap by 0.028–0.035, half of a measured neighbour pair (crosses in Figure 3; dotted segments in Figure 2). No unmeasured pair of the fixed-Δz layouts overlaps by more than 10^{-6} after the blur. The measured BGS–LRG1 boundary pair of $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc overlaps by 3×10^{-7}: its ranges are 0.010 apart, six times σ_z.

6.6 Raw $n(z)$ for the rule, blurred $n(z)$ for the model

The pairing rule, Eq. (2), reads the raw $n(z)$: the pair list is fixed with the data and does not move when σ_v is sampled. The model reads the blurred $n(z)$ in every spectrum it computes: the autos, the measured cross spectra and the stochastic templates. The covariance uses the blurred $n(z)$ at the default σ_v.

For the three fixed-Δz layouts the two choices give the same list: no unmeasured pair overlaps after the blur, and every measured pair overlaps by at least 0.003. On $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc a rule applied to the blurred $n(z)$ would add the ten LRG3–ELG1 pairs above and drop the BGS–LRG1 boundary pair.

7 What is not measured, and why that is a choice

Unmeasured spectra are not zero. Two thin bins one apart share no galaxies and, even blurred, no redshift range, so their cross spectrum vanishes in the Limber regime. At low ℓ it does not vanish: modes longer than a bin along the line of sight connect the two shells (Section 2), so their non-Limber cross spectrum is small but nonzero. The same holds for any pair beyond. On $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc the ten misaligned LRG3–ELG1 pairs are larger still: their blurred kernels overlap like those of neighbours.

Leaving a spectrum out is a choice of data, not an error. The likelihood compares each spectrum in the data vector with the model's prediction for that same spectrum, weighted by the covariance of the measured spectra. Leaving a pair out removes its rows from the data, the model and the covariance together. The remaining comparison is still a correct one; it uses less information. So the choice can cost precision, by the information the unmeasured spectra carry, but it cannot bias a fit: a bias would need a wrong prediction for a spectrum that is kept, and leaving another spectrum out changes no prediction.

8 Open issues

- **The ten misaligned LRG3–ELG1 pairs of $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc.** The pair list, from the DESI forecast and reproduced by the rule on the raw $n(z)$, leaves them out, although their blurred kernels overlap by 0.028–0.035. Their information is not in the forecast.
- **The BGS–LRG1 boundary pair of $\Delta d_{\rm com} = 62$ Mpc.** It is measured although its ranges are 0.010 apart and its blurred kernels do not overlap (3×10^{-7}); its signal is the low-ℓ non-Limber correlation alone.
- **The list does not follow σ_v.** A sampled σ_v changes every kernel overlap but not which pairs are measured. Within two prior widths of the defaults no unmeasured pair of the fixed-Δz layouts reaches an overlap of 10^{-4}.

Reproducing the figures. `plots/make_cross_correlations_data.py` reads the project's `data/` and `likelihood/` files and writes the `data.json` of the three figure folders, with every number quoted here. Each folder's `plot_<name>.py` redraws its figure from that file alone.

References

[1] D. N. Limber, "The Analysis of Counts of the Extragalactic Nebulae in Terms of a Fluctuating Density Field", ApJ 117, 134 (1953).

[2] U. Seljak, "Extracting primordial non-Gaussianity without cosmic variance", Phys. Rev. Lett. 102, 021302 (2009), arXiv:0807.1770.

[3] J. C. Jackson, "A critique of Rees's theory of primordial gravitational radiation", MNRAS 156, 1P (1972).

[4] N. Kaiser, "Clustering in real space and in redshift space", MNRAS 227, 1 (1987).

[5] H. S. Grasshorn Gebhardt and D. Jeong, "Nonlinear redshift-space distortions in the harmonic-space galaxy power spectrum", Phys. Rev. D 102, 083521 (2020).